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Battery pack

Abstract

Disclosed is a battery pack in which a seating recess is provided in a horizontal frame so that connection members pass through the horizontal frame through the seating recess, thereby maximizing a height of the horizontal frame. A vertical frame cover is provided in a vertical frame to secure a height of the vertical frame side in each module space. A sealing member is provided in the seating recess to seal the seating recess. A double shielding structure, including a module space cover shielding each module space and a battery pack cover shielding a battery pack housing as a whole, is provided to maximize airtightness of the battery pack.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims priority to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2021-0054170 filed Apr. 27, 2021, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

(2) The following disclosure relates to a battery pack, and in particular, to a battery pack in which a seating recess is provided in a horizontal frame so that connection members pass through the horizontal frame through the seating recess, thereby maximizing a height of the horizontal frame, a vertical frame cover is provided in a vertical frame to secure a height of the vertical frame side in each module space, a sealing member is provided in the seating recess to seal the seating recess, and a double shielding structure, including a module space cover shielding each module space and a battery pack cover shielding a battery pack housing as a whole, is provided to maximize airtightness of the battery pack.

Description of Related Art

(3) Secondary batteries having high ease of application and electrical characteristics such as high energy density according to product groups have been universally applied to electric vehicles (EVs) or hybrid vehicles (HEVs) driven by an electric drive source as well as portable devices. Secondary batteries have come into prominence as a new energy resource which is eco-friendly and improves energy efficiency in that no byproducts occur in using energy, as well as primary advantages of remarkably reducing the use of fossil fuels.

(4) Types of currently widely used secondary batteries include lithium ion batteries, lithium polymer batteries, nickel cadmium batteries, nickel hydride batteries, nickel zinc batteries, and the like. An operating voltage of such a unit secondary battery cell, that is, a unit battery cell, is about 2.5 V to 4.6 V. Therefore, when a higher output voltage is required, a battery pack may be configured by connecting a plurality of battery cells in series. In addition, a battery pack may be configured by connecting a plurality of battery cells in parallel according to charge/discharge capacity required for the battery pack. Accordingly, the number of battery cells included in the

battery pack may be set to be various according to required output voltages or charge/discharge capacities.

(5) Meanwhile, in the case of configuring a battery pack by connecting a plurality of battery cells in series/parallel, generally, a method of first configuring a battery module including at least one battery cell and configuring a battery pack by adding other components using the at least one battery module. Here, the battery module or battery cells configuring the battery pack may be provided as a pouch-type secondary battery which is generally easily stacked.

(6) FIG. 1 is a top view of a battery pack case of the related art, and FIG. 2 is a partial perspective view of FIG. 1. A battery pack case 50 may include a plate 51 corresponding to a bottom surface on which battery modules are placed, an outer frame 52 formed at an outer portion of the plate 51, and a plurality of inner frames 53 formed in a grid form on an inner side of the outer frame. Battery modules are separately placed in an internal space C defined by the plate 51 and each frame 52 and 53.

(7) In the case of a battery module, a thermal runaway situation may occur in which ignition of a battery cell occurs inside the case due to overcharging, etc., and here, high temperature and high pressure gas, flames, and metal particles may occur in a corresponding trigger cell or a trigger module including the trigger cell. In this case, high temperature and high pressure gas or flames may thermally propagate from an internal space including the trigger module to another internal space to damage a normal module, and at the same time, flames or the like, that occur in the trigger module may be exposed externally of the battery pack case to lead to more significant secondary damage.

RELATED ART DOCUMENT

Patent Document

(8) (Patent document 1) Japanese Patent Publication No. 5853417 (published on Dec. 18, 2015).

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(9) An exemplary embodiment of the present invention is directed to providing a battery pack in which a seating recess is provided in a horizontal frame so that connection members pass through the horizontal frame through the seating recess, thereby maximizing a height of the horizontal frame, a vertical frame cover is provided in a vertical frame to secure a height of the vertical frame side in each module space, a sealing member is provided in the seating recess to seal the seating recess, and a double shielding structure, including a module space cover shielding each module space and a battery pack cover shielding a battery pack housing as a whole, is provided to maximize airtightness of the battery pack.

(10) In one general aspect, a battery pack includes: a plate in which battery modules are placed; an outer frame provided with a predetermined height at an outer portion of the plate; and at least one inner frame dividing the internal space so that the battery modules are placed in the internal space formed by the plate and the outer frame, wherein the internal frame include at least one seating recesses formed by indenting an upper surface of the internal frame downward.

(11) The internal frame may include at least one horizontal frame and at least one vertical frame dividing the internal space in a grid form.

(12) The seating recess may include a central seating recess provided near an intersection at which the vertical frame and the horizontal frame meet.

(13) The central seating recess may include a first central seating recess and a second central seating recess provided on both sides with respect to a center of the vertical frame.

(14) The seating recess may include a side seating recess provided on at least one of both ends of the horizontal frame in a length direction.

(15) The vertical frame may include a plurality of unit vertical frames, and the horizontal frame may be disposed between two adjacent unit vertical frames among the plurality of unit vertical frames.

(16) The battery pack may further include a plurality of unit vertical frame covers provided at

upper portions of the plurality of unit vertical frames to cover upper portions of the unit vertical frames, respectively.

(17) The battery pack may further include: a connection member including at least one of a busbar electrically connecting the battery modules and a wire harness providing an electrical signal to electrical equipment provided in a battery housing, wherein at least a portion of the connection member is seated in the seating recess.

(18) The battery pack may further include: a sealing member coupled to the seating recess, wherein the sealing member seals a space other than a space occupied by the connection member in the seating recess.

(19) At least a portion of the connection member and the sealing member may be coupled to each other.

(20) The horizontal frame may have the same height as the outer frame, and the vertical frame may be lower than the horizontal frame.

(21) The connection member may be located above the vertical frame, and a vertical frame cover covering the connection member may be further provided above the vertical frame.

(22) The battery pack may further include: a plurality of module space covers provided above a plurality of module spaces formed by dividing the internal space in a grid form to shield the module spaces, respectively; and a battery pack cover provided above the plurality of module space covers and above the battery pack housing to shield the internal space of the battery pack housing as a whole.

(23) The plurality of module space covers and the battery pack covers may be spaced apart from each other.

(24) A seating structure on which the module space cover may be placed may be provided on a side surface of the horizontal frame, and the seating structure may be provided in a position lower than an upper surface of the horizontal frame.

(25) The battery module may include a battery cell assembly including a pouch-type battery cell and a module case fixing the battery cell assembly, and the pouch-type battery cell may be directly seated on the plate through a thermally conductive member.

(26) Other features and aspects will be apparent from the following detailed description, the drawings, and the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a top view of a battery pack case of the related art.

(2) FIG. 2 is a partial perspective view of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view of a battery pack according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 4 is an exploded perspective view of the battery module of the related art.

(5) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of a battery pack housing according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(6) FIG. 6 is a side view of a horizontal frame according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(7) FIG. 7 is an exploded perspective view of a battery pack housing according to another exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(8) FIG. 8 is a combined view of FIG. 7.

(9) FIG. 9 is an enlarged view of a region A of FIG. 8.

(10) FIG. 10 is an exploded perspective view of FIG. 8.

(11) FIG. 11 is an exploded perspective view of a battery pack housing according to another

exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(12) FIG. 12 is a combined view of FIG. 11.

(13) FIGS. 13 and 14 are top views of a battery pack housing according to another exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(14) FIG. 15 is a top view of a battery pack housing according to another exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

(15) FIG. 16 shows again FIG. 5.

(16) FIG. 17 is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A' of FIG. 3.

(17) FIG. 18 is a cross-sectional view taken along line B-B' of FIG. 3.

(18) FIG. 19 is an exploded perspective view of a battery module according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(19) Hereinafter, exemplary embodiments will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings.

(20) FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view of a battery pack 10 according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention. The battery pack 10 of the present invention may include a battery pack case 20 and battery modules 300 accommodated in the battery pack case 20. The battery pack case 20 may include a battery pack housing 100 and an upper cover 200 covering an upper portion of the battery pack housing.

(21) First, the battery module 300 may be a general battery module. For example, FIG. 4 shows the battery module 300 according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention. The battery module 300 may be formed by accommodating a battery cell assembly including stacked battery cells 310 with multiple battery cells 311 stacked therein in a case 320. The case 320 may include a lower plate 321 covering a lower surface of the battery cell assembly including a plurality of stacked battery cells, a side plate 322 covering both side surfaces of the battery cell assembly, a front cover 323 covering a front surface of the battery cell assembly, a rear cover 324 covering a rear surface of the battery cell assembly, and an upper cover 325 covering an upper surface of the battery cell assembly. The battery cell of the battery module may be provided as a pouch-type secondary battery, an angular secondary battery, or a cylindrical secondary battery, and the battery module of the present invention may be a battery module including pouch-type secondary batteries as shown in FIG. 4. Meanwhile, the battery module may refer to a battery module assembly formed by connecting two or more single battery module structures as described above.

(22) Hereinafter, the battery pack housing 100 of the present invention will be described first. The battery pack housing 100 provides a space in which the battery modules 300 are seated. In the present invention, the battery pack housing 100 refers to a housing excluding the upper cover 200 from the battery pack case 20. FIG. 5 is a perspective view of a battery pack housing according to an example of the present invention. As shown, the battery pack housing 100 according to an example of the present invention may include a plate 110, an outer frame 120, and an inner frame, and the inner frame may include a horizontal frame 130 and a vertical frame 140.

(23) The plate 110 is a place where the battery modules are placed. The plate may be configured in a flat plate shape having an approximately large area, and may be located under the battery modules to cover a lower portion of the battery module.

(24) The outer frame 120 is formed at a predetermined height on an outer portion of the plate. The outer frame 120 may include a left frame 121, a right frame 122, a front frame 123, and a rear frame 124 which are arranged on the left, right, front, and rear of the plate along an outer circumference of the plate to cover side surfaces of the battery modules.

(25) The inner frame divides the internal space formed by the plate 110 and the outer frame 120 into a plurality of spaces, and the inner frame may include at least one seating recess formed by indenting a portion of an upper surface of the inner frame downward. The inner frame may include the horizontal frame 130 and the vertical frame 140, and accordingly, the horizontal frame 130 and

the vertical frame **140** may have a seating recess having the structure described above. Hereinafter, the present invention will be described based on the seating recess formed in the horizontal frame **130**.

(26) More specifically, the horizontal frame **130** and the vertical frame **140** are installed in a grid form on an inner side of the outer frame **120** to divide the internal space defined in a box shape by the plate **110** and the outer frame **120** into a plurality of areas. The horizontal frame **130** may be installed in a horizontal direction (i.e., in a left-right direction among the directions indicated in FIG. 5) on an upper surface of the plate **110**, and the vertical frame **140** may be installed in a vertical direction (i.e., in a front-rear direction among the directions indicated in FIG. 5) on the upper surface of the plate **110**.

(27) FIG. 5 shows that four horizontal frames **130** are installed and one vertical frame **140** is installed in the center, but the present invention is not limited thereto, and a plurality of vertical frames **140**, as well as the horizontal frames **130**, may be provided, and only one horizontal frame **130** may be provided. In this manner, since the horizontal frame **130** and the vertical frame **140** are installed in a grid form, the internal space defined by the plate and the outer frame is divided into a plurality of areas, and thus, the battery modules may be individually seated in the corresponding areas, respectively. In this case, each of the areas will be defined as a module area M in the present invention.

(28) Here, the horizontal frame **130** of the present invention may include a seating recess in which a connection member to be described later may be seated. More specifically, FIG. 6 is a side view of a horizontal frame according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, and as shown, at least one seating recess **135** may be formed in the horizontal frame **130**, and here, the seating recess **135** may be formed by indenting an upper surface of the horizontal frame **130** downward.

(29) The seating recess **135** may include a central seating recess **136**, and the central seating recess **136** may be formed near an intersection at which the vertical frame **140** and the horizontal frame **130** meet. That is, referring to FIG. 5 again, the intersection formed as the vertical frame **140** and the horizontal frame **130** meet may be located near the center of the horizontal frame **130**, and the seating recess **135** may be located near the center of the horizontal frame **130** in which the intersection is located. Alternatively, when the intersection formed as the vertical frame **140** and the horizontal frame **130** meet is eccentric to one side near the center of the horizontal frame **130**, the seating recess **135** may also be formed near the eccentric intersection.

(30) The central seating recess **136** may include a first central seating recess **136-1** and a second central seating recess **136-2** formed on both sides with respect to the center of the vertical frame **140**. That is, as shown in FIGS. 5 and 6, the central seating recess **136** may be formed near the intersection of the horizontal frame **130** and the vertical frame **140** and may face each other with reference to the center of the vertical frame **140**, i.e., in a length direction in which the vertical frame **140** extends. Accordingly, based on the vertical frame **140**, a structure of the battery pack housing positioned on the left of the vertical frame **140** and a structure of the battery pack housing positioned on the right of the vertical frame **140** may be symmetric with each other.

(31) In addition, the seating recess **135** may include a side seating recess **137**, and the side seating recess **137** may be formed on at least one of both ends of the horizontal frame **130** in the length direction (i.e., in the left-right direction among the directions indicated in FIG. 6). FIG. 6 shows that side seating recesses are formed at both ends of the horizontal frame in the length direction, respectively.

(32) Hereinafter, a battery pack housing **100** according to another example of the present invention will be described. FIG. 7 is an exploded perspective view of a battery pack housing according to another example of the present invention, FIG. 8 is a combined view of FIG. 7, FIG. 9 is an enlarged view of a region A of FIG. 8, and FIG. 10 is an exploded view of FIG. 8. The battery pack housing **100** according to the present example may further include a vertical frame cover **150**, a

connection member **160**, and a sealing member **170**, in addition to the plate **110**, the outer frame **120**, the horizontal frame **130**, and the vertical frame **140** described above.

(33) In this example, the horizontal frame **130** is formed to have the same height as the outer frame **120**, the vertical frame **140** may be formed to be lower than the horizontal frame **130**. The horizontal frame **130** may be formed to have a height equal to a height of the left frame **121** and the right frame **122** on both sides of the outer frame **120** in a width direction, and the vertical frame **140** may be formed to be lower than the height of the horizontal frame **130**.

(34) In this case, since airtightness between the two adjacent module spaces **M** adjacent in the horizontal direction with the vertical frame **140** therebetween may be reduced by the low height of the vertical frame **140**, and thus, the vertical frame cover **150** may be further provided to complement the reduction in airtightness. The vertical frame cover **150** may be provided above the vertical frame **140** to cover the vertical frame **140**.

(35) Meanwhile, in this example, the vertical frame **140** may be formed of a plurality of unit vertical frames **140U**. That is, referring to FIG. 7, the horizontal frame **130** is formed to be integrated and installed in the horizontal direction between the left frame **121** and the right frame **122**, and the vertical frame **140** may include a plurality of separated unit vertical frames **140U** inserted between the rear frame **124** and the horizontal frame **130**, between two adjacent horizontal frames **130**, and between the horizontal frame **130** and the front frame **123** and installed in a vertical direction, and accordingly, the horizontal frame **130** may be disposed between two adjacent unit vertical frames **140U** among the plurality of vertical frames **140U**. In this manner, when the vertical frame **140** includes a plurality of unit vertical frames **140U**, the vertical frame cover **150** described above also includes a plurality of separate unit vertical frame covers **150U** which may be provided on top of the plurality of unit vertical frames **140U**, respectively.

(36) Further, in this example, a connection member **160** including a busbar for electrically connecting the battery modules **M** and a wire harness for providing electrical signals to electrical equipment provided in the battery pack housing may be further included. The busbar may be a rod-shaped conductor connecting two adjacent battery modules, and the wire harness may be a unit providing power and electrical signals to electrical equipment, for example, a cell management unit (CMU), and including peripheral components such as wires and connectors integrated therein.

(37) Here, at least a portion of the connection member **160** may be seated in the seating recess **135**. For example, referring to FIG. 10, the horizontal frame **130** may include the seating recess **135** including a first central seating recess **136-1** and a second central seating recess **136-2**, and here, a central portion of the busbar and a portion of the harness may be seated in the first central seating recess **136-1**, and a central portion of another busbar and a portion of another harness may be seated in the second central seating recess **136-2**. In addition, referring to FIG. 7, the horizontal frame **130** may have side seating recesses **137** formed at both ends of the horizontal frame **130** in the length direction, and a central portion of the extended busbar may be seated in the side seating recess **137**.

(38) Here, in the present invention, a sealing member **170** may be provided in the seating recess **135**. Referring to FIG. 10, the sealing member **170** may be provided in the seating recess **135** to seal a space other than the space occupied by the connection member **160** in the seating recess **135**. The sealing member may include a fire-resistant, heat-resistant, non-flammable material, and, for example, such material may correspond to MICA, resin, EPDM, composite materials, and metal materials.

(39) Here, as shown in FIG. 10, at least a portion of the connection member **160** and the sealing member **170** may be coupled to each other. That is, the sealing member **170** may be coupled to the corresponding portion of the connection member **160** to correspond to the portion that is seated in the seating recess **135**.

(40) In the following, a battery pack housing **100** according to another example of the present invention will be described. FIG. 11 is an exploded perspective view of a battery pack housing

according to another example of the present invention, and FIG. 12 is a combined view of FIG. 11. The battery pack housing **100** according to the present example may further include a vertical frame cover **150**, a connection member **160**, and a sensing member **180**, in addition to the plate **110**, the outer frame **120**, the horizontal frame **130**, and the vertical frame **140** described above.

(41) In this example, the vertical frame **140** may include at least one of one side fastening recess **145_R** in which one surface (e.g., a right surface of the vertical frame) of the vertical frame **140** is concave inward with respect to each of the module spaces **M** located in one direction (e.g., a rightward direction of the vertical frame) of the vertical frame **140**, among the plurality of module spaces **M** and the other side fastening recess **145_L** in which the other surface (e.g., a left surface of the vertical frame) of the vertical frame **140** with respect to each of the module spaces **M** located in the other direction (e.g., a leftward direction of the vertical frame) of the vertical frame **140** among the plurality of module spaces **M**. That is, the vertical frame **140** of the present invention may include a fastening recess **145** formed such that at least one of the side surfaces of the vertical frame **140** is recessed inward, and here, the fastening recess **145** includes one side fastening recess **145_R** and the other side fastening recess **145_L** described above.

(42) FIGS. 13 and 14 are top views of a battery pack housing according to another example of the present invention. FIG. 13 shows that one vertical frame **140** is provided and one side fastening recess **145_R** and the other side fastening recess **145_L** are formed on both sides of the vertical frame **140** with respect to each of the module spaces **M** located on both sides (i.e., both one side and the other side) of the vertical frame **140**, and FIG. 14 shows that two vertical frames **140** are provided, and in the case of a first vertical frame **140-1** provided on the left in the drawing, one side fastening recess **145_R** and the other side fastening recess **145_L** are formed on both sides of the first vertical frame **140-1** with respect to each of the module spaces **M** located on both sides of the first vertical frame **140-1**, and in the case of a second vertical frame **140-2**, one side fastening recess **145_R** is formed on the right side of the second vertical frame **140-2** with respect to each of the module spaces **M** located on the right side (e.g., one side) of the second vertical frame **140-2**. That is, in this example, at least one of the one side fastening recess **145_R** and the other side fastening recess **145_L** may be formed in at least one of the vertical frames **140** forming each module space **M**.

(43) FIG. 15 is a top view of a battery pack housing according to another exemplary embodiment of the present invention. As shown, in the case of the present exemplary embodiment, unlike FIGS. 13 and 14, the module space **M** may be configured only with horizontal frames without a separate vertical frame). In this manner, even when the module space is divided only by horizontal frames, the seating recess **135** according to the present invention may be formed to have the same structure as in FIG. 6, and such a structure as the fastening recess **145** of the vertical frame **140** described above may be formed on the side surface of the outer frame **120** of the battery pack housing **100**. Accordingly, in this case, a fastening recess **125** may be formed on the side surface of the outer frame **120**.

(44) As described above, the present invention may have the fastening recess so that at least one of both side surfaces of each of the outer frame and the inner frame is indented inward in at least one of the outer frame and the inner frame. More specifically, in the outer frame **120**, an outer frame fastening recess **125** may be formed by indenting inward a partial region of a side surface corresponding to a side surface of the outer frame **120** facing the module space **M**, and, in particular, in the vertical frame **140** of the inner frame, a vertical frame fastening recess **145** may be formed by indenting inward a partial region of at least one of both side surfaces of the vertical frame **140**. Meanwhile, hereinafter, the present invention will be described based on the vertical frame **140**.

(45) In this example, a sensing member **180** may be fastened to each of one side fastening recess **145_R** and the other fastening recess **145_L** formed in the vertical frame **140**. The sensing member **180** is electronic equipment that measures a state of the battery module **300** individually seated in

each module space M, and may be, for example, a battery management unit (CMU) described above.

(46) Here, the one side fastening recess **145_R** and the other side fastening recess **145_L** formed in the vertical frame **140** may have a fastening recess fixing unit **147** for fixing a sensing member fastened to the corresponding fastening recesses **145_R** and **145_L**. As shown in FIG. **11**, the one or the other side fastening recesses **145_R** and **145_L** formed in the vertical frame **140** may have a fixing unit **147** for coupling the sensing member **180** to the corresponding fastening recess. Further, the sensing member **180** may have a fixing bracket **187** corresponding to the fixing unit **147**. That is, referring to FIG. **11**, the sensing member **180** may be inserted into one or the other side fastening recesses **145_R** and **145_L** formed in the vertical frame **140**, the fixing bracket **187** may be provided on an outer side of the sensing member **180** to fix the sensing member **180**, and a bolt coupling portion protruding from an outer wall of the fastening recesses **145_R** and **145_L** in positions corresponding to the fixing bracket **187**, so that the sensing member **180** may be firmly fixed to the outer wall of the fastening recesses **145_R** and **145_L** through bolting coupling between the bracket **187** of the sensing member **180** and the bolt coupling portion. The fixing unit formed in the fastening recess may be, for example, a bolt coupling portion.

(47) Meanwhile, in this example, a vertical frame cover **150** may be further provided on the vertical frame **140**. In addition, the vertical frame **140** may include a plurality of unit vertical frames **140U**, and each of the unit vertical frames **140U** may include at least any one of a unit one side fastening recess **145_RU** in which one side surface of the unit vertical frame **140U** is formed to be concave inward with respect to the module space M located in one direction of each of the unit vertical frames **140U** and a unit other side fastening recess **145_LU** in which the other side surface of the unit vertical frame **140U** is formed to be concave inward with respect to the module space M located in the other direction of each of the unit vertical frames **140U**. Here, the unit one side fastening recess and the unit other side fastening recess may have a unit fastening recess fixing unit **147U** for fixing a sensing member fastened to the unit one side fastening recess and the unit other side fastening recess.

(48) In addition, when the vertical frame **140** includes the plurality of unit vertical frames **140U**, the vertical frame cover **150** may also include a plurality of unit vertical frame covers **150U** provided in an upper portion of each of the unit vertical frames **140U** to cover the upper portion of each of the unit vertical frames **140U**. Furthermore, also, in this example, a seating recess **135** is formed in the horizontal frame **130**, and at least a portion of the connection member **180** may be seated on the seating recess **135**. In this example, detailed content overlapping the previous content will be omitted.

(49) Hereinafter, the battery pack case **20** will be described. Referring back to FIG. **3**, the battery pack case **20** may include the battery pack housing **100** and the upper cover **200** described above, and in this case, the upper cover **200** may include a plurality of module space covers **210** and a battery pack cover **220**.

(50) The module space cover **210** may be provided on each of the plurality of module spaces M to shield each module space M, and module space covers **210** as many as the number of each module space M may be provided. That is, the module space cover **200** may be positioned above each battery module **300** seated in each module space M to cover the upper portion of each battery module **300**. Here, the module space cover **200** may include a fire-resistant, heat-resistant, and non-flammable material, and, for example, such material may correspond to MICA, resin, EPDM, composite materials, and metal materials.

(51) The battery pack cover **220** may be provided on top of the plurality of module space covers **200** and on the top of the battery pack housing **100** to shield the internal space of the battery pack housing **100** as a whole, and may be formed as a plate having a sufficient size to cover the entirety of the internal space.

(52) As such, the upper cover **200** of the battery pack case **20** of the present invention may have a

double shielding structure including a plurality of separate module space covers **210** shielding each module space **M** and one battery pack cover **220** that shields the internal space of the battery pack housing **100** overall.

(53) Here, the plurality of module space covers **210** and the battery pack cover **220** may be spaced apart from each other by a predetermined distance. This is to secure a heat insulating layer by forming a space between the module space cover **210** and the battery pack cover **220**, and as a specific means, as shown in FIG. **16**, a seating structure **139** may be provided so that the module space cover **210** may be mounted on the horizontal frame **130** or on a side surface (e.g., a left surface and a right surface of the horizontal frame) of the horizontal frame **130** and the outer frame **120** as shown in FIG. **16**. Here, the seating structure **139** may be formed in a position lower than an upper surface of the horizontal frame **130** and the outer frame **120** so that the module space cover **210** may be placed on the seating structure **139** and the battery pack cover **220** may be placed on the upper surface of the horizontal frame **130** and the outer frame **120**, so that the module space cover **210** and the battery pack cover **220** may be spaced apart by a predetermined distance in a height direction. FIG. **17** is a cross-sectional view of A-A' of FIG. **3**, and FIG. **18** is a cross-sectional view of B-B' of FIG. **3**, illustrating a coupling structure between the horizontal frame **130**, the seating structure **139** of the horizontal frame, the vertical frame **140**, the vertical frame cover **150**, the module space cover **210** and the battery pack cover **220**.

(54) Meanwhile, the battery pack **10** of the present invention may include the battery module **300** and the battery module **300** individually seated in each of the battery pack case **20** and a plurality of module spaces **M** of the battery pack case **20** as described above.

(55) Here, the battery module **300** applied to the present invention may include a pouch-type battery cell assembly **350** formed by stacking pouch-type battery cells and a module case **360** for fixing the battery cell assembly **350**, and the module case is simplified so that the battery cell assembly may be directly seated on the battery pack case.

(56) More specifically, FIG. **19** shows a battery module according to an example of the present invention. As shown, the battery module **300** of the present invention may include the pouch-type battery cell assembly **350** and the module case **360**, and the module case **360** of the present invention may include a side cover **362** surrounding both sides of the battery cell assembly **350**, a front plate **363** covering the front surface, and a rear plate **364** covering the rear surface, and a connection bar **365** connecting the front plate and the rear plate may be additionally provided on an upper portion of the battery cell assembly.

(57) That is, the battery module of the present invention may not have an upper cover and a lower cover surrounding the upper and lower portions of the battery cell assembly, unlike the general battery module of the related art described above, and in particular, the battery module of the present invention may not have a lower cover. This simplifies the module case by removing unnecessary parts from the module case of the battery module of the related art, and by reducing the size of the battery module, a storage ratio of the battery cell to a total volume of the battery pack may be increased.

(58) In addition, in the battery module of the related art, a thermally conductive member (e.g., a thermally conductive resin layer) **330** is disposed on an upper portion of the module case lower cover **321** as described with reference to FIG. **4**, whereby when the battery module **300** is seated on the plate **110** of the battery pack, the lower cover **321** of the module case may be located between the battery cell assembly **310** and the plate **110**, degrading heat exchange performance between the battery cell assembly **310** and the plate **110**, and in order to solve this problem, a second thermally conductive resin layer (not shown) should be additionally provided between the battery module **300** and the plate **110**. In contrast, in the battery module of the present invention, the module case does not have a lower cover so that the battery cell assembly **350** and the plate **110** are in direct contact with each other, whereby there is no need to provide a thermally conductive resin layer in the battery module itself and only a single thermally conductive resin layer provided between the

battery module **300** and the plate **110** may have sufficient heat exchange performance, thus reducing the use of a thermally conductive resin, and since heat exchange takes place directly between the battery cell assembly **350** and the plate **110**, heat-exchange performance may be further improved.

(59) As described above, according to the present invention, a seating recess is formed in the horizontal frame, so that a connection member such as various busbars and wire harnesses required to configure a battery pack through the corresponding seating recess may be easily installed.

(60) In addition, the connection member may pass through the horizontal frame through the seating recess, so that a height of the horizontal frame may be secured as much as possible at a level equal to a height of the outer frame, and thus airtightness of the horizontal frame side in the module space may be maximized.

(61) In addition, by providing the sealing member in the seating recess, it is possible to reliably prevent gas and flames in a trigger module from propagating to other module spaces through the seating recess.

(62) In addition, since the connection member and the sealing member are coupled to each other, it is easy to mount a coupling structure of the connection member and the sealing member in the seating recess, and the corresponding coupling structure may be firmly mounted in the seating recess.

(63) In addition, convenience of assembly may be increased by configuring the vertical frame as a plurality of unit vertical frames and inserting and installing each unit vertical frame between the outer frame and the horizontal frame.

(64) In addition, as the fastening recess is formed on the side of the vertical frame, the height of the vertical frame may be configured close to the height of the outer frame, so that airtightness toward the vertical frame in the module space may be secured.

(65) In addition, as the vertical frame cover is provided on the upper portion of the vertical frame, airtightness toward the vertical frame in the module space may be further secured.

(66) In addition, since the fastening recess is provided on the side of the vertical frame and a sensing member, that is, a CMU, may be fastened to the fastening recess, space utilization in the battery pack may be maximized, thereby increasing energy density of the battery pack.

(67) In addition, the sensing member fixing unit may be provided in the fastening recess of the vertical frame, so that the sensing member may be firmly fixed to the fastening recess.

(68) In addition, since the upper cover of the battery pack housing is designed to have a double shielding structure including the module space cover shielding each module space and the battery pack cover shielding the entire internal space of the battery pack housing, smoke and flames generated by the trigger module may be reliably blocked from propagating externally and being transferred to a cabin.

(69) In addition, since the module space cover and the battery pack cover are separated, an insulating layer is formed therebetween, thereby preventing heat generated in the module space from being transferred to the outside.

(70) In addition, since the battery module having a simplified module case is applied, a ratio of the battery cell to a total volume of the battery pack may be increased to increase an overall capacity of the battery, and since the battery cell assembly and the plate are in direct contact with each other, the use of a thermally conductive resin layer may be reduced and heat exchange performance may be further improved.

(71) According to the present invention, a seating recess is formed in the horizontal frame, so that a connection member such as various busbars and wire harnesses required to configure a battery pack through the corresponding seating recess may be easily installed.

(72) In addition, the connection member may pass through the horizontal frame through the seating recess, so that a height of the horizontal frame may be secured as much as possible at a level equal to a height of the outer frame, and thus airtightness of the horizontal frame side in the module space

may be maximized.

(73) In addition, as the fastening recess is formed on the side of the vertical frame, the height of the vertical frame may be configured close to the height of the outer frame, so that airtightness toward the vertical frame in the module space may be secured.

(74) In addition, as the vertical frame cover is provided on the upper portion of the vertical frame, airtightness toward the vertical frame in the module space may be further secured.

(75) In addition, by providing the sealing member in the seating recess, it is possible to reliably prevent gas and flames in a trigger module from propagating to other module spaces through the seating recess.

(76) In addition, since the upper cover of the battery pack housing is designed to have a double shielding structure including the module space cover shielding each module space and the battery pack cover shielding the entire internal space of the battery pack housing, smoke and flames generated by the trigger module may be reliably blocked from propagating externally and being transferred to a cabin.

(77) Although the exemplary embodiments of the present invention have been described above with reference to the accompanying drawings, a person skilled in the art to which the present invention pertains will understand that the present invention may be implemented in any other specific forms without changing the technical spirit or essential features thereof. Therefore, it should be understood that the embodiments described above are exemplary in all respects and not restrictive.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF MAIN ELEMENTS

(78) **10**: battery pack **20**: battery pack case **100**: battery pack housing **110**: plate **120**: outer frame **130**: horizontal frame **140**: vertical frame **140U**: unit vertical frame **150**: vertical frame cover **150U**: unit vertical frame cover **160**: connection member **170**: sealing member **180**: sensing member **200**: upper cover **210**: module space cover **220**: battery pack cover **300**: battery module

Claims

1. A battery pack comprising: a plate in which battery modules are placed; an outer frame provided with a predetermined height at an outer portion of the plate; at least one inner frame dividing an internal space so that the battery modules are placed in the internal space formed by the plate and the outer frame; and a connection member including at least one of a busbar electrically connecting the battery modules and a wire harness providing an electrical signal to electrical equipment provided in a battery housing, wherein the at least one inner frame includes at least one horizontal frame and at least one vertical frame, the internal space is divided into a plurality of areas by the horizontal frame and vertical frame, and the battery modules are individually seated in each area, wherein the horizontal frame includes at least one seating recess formed by indenting an upper surface of the at least one inner frame downward, wherein at least a portion of the connection member is seated in the seating recess, and wherein the connection member is configured to pass through the horizontal frame through the seating recess wherein the horizontal frame has the same height as the outer frame, and the vertical frame is lower than the horizontal frame wherein the connection member is located above the vertical frame, and a vertical frame cover covering the connection member is further provided above the vertical frame.

2. The battery pack of claim 1, wherein the at least one seating recess includes a central seating recess provided near an intersection at which the vertical frame and the horizontal frame meet.

3. The battery pack of claim 2, wherein the central seating recess includes a first central seating recess and a second central seating recess provided on both sides with respect to a center of the vertical frame.

4. The battery pack of claim 1, wherein the at least one seating recess includes a side seating recess provided on at least one of the ends of the at least one horizontal frame in a length direction.

5. The battery pack of claim 1, wherein the at least one vertical frame includes a plurality of unit vertical frames, and the at least one horizontal frame is disposed between two adjacent unit vertical frames among the plurality of unit vertical frames.
 6. The battery pack of claim 5, further comprising: a plurality of unit vertical frame covers provided at upper portions of the plurality of unit vertical frames to cover upper portions of the unit vertical frames, respectively.
 7. The battery pack of claim 1, further comprising: a sealing member coupled to the seating recess, wherein the sealing member seals a space other than a space occupied by the connection member in the seating recess.
 8. The battery pack of claim 7, wherein at least a portion of the connection member and the sealing member are coupled to each other.
 9. The battery pack of claim 1, further comprising: a plurality of module space covers provided above a plurality of module spaces formed by dividing the internal space in a grid form to shield the module spaces, respectively; and a battery pack cover provided above the plurality of module space covers and above a battery pack housing to shield the internal space of the battery pack housing as a whole.
 10. The battery pack of claim 9, wherein the plurality of module space covers and the battery pack covers are spaced apart from each other.
 11. The battery pack of claim 9, further comprising: a seating structure on which the module space cover is placed is provided on a side surface of the at least one horizontal frame, and the seating structure is provided in a position lower than an upper surface of the at least one horizontal frame.
 12. The battery pack of claim 1, wherein the battery module includes a battery cell assembly including a pouch-type battery cell and a module case fixing the battery cell assembly, and the pouch-type battery cell is directly seated on the plate through a thermally conductive member.
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